SNAKES

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Project Introduction

Project Overview

Problems:

Snakes are often seen as scary or evil in media, but your common pet snake, such as a corn snake, is significantly less dangerous than a dog. I want more people to be able to learn about snakes and the ability to have them as wonderful pets rather than fear them.

While many people do research before purchasing a snake, informational sites can have very lengthy paragraphs that many users will just skip over. This leads to missing important information or a user potentially giving up.

Goals:

Introduce users to a variety of beginner friendly snake species while educating them on different aspects of the snake and what is needed to keep them as a pet.

Keeping the user engaged though interactive elements and graphics while still delivering the needed information.

Motivation:

I believe snakes are very beautiful and unique animals. I have had a love for keeping reptiles since I was young and I want to share the experience. The fear of snakes has become a rather common thing, but I believe if people are able to learn more about snakes this fear can be reduced.

Project Overview

Target Audience:

The target audience is adults ranging from ages 18 to 60. This site can be used by anyone interested in learning about snakes or interested in purchasing a snake themselves.

User Needs:

To create an engaging experience for the user, this website would need many ways to effectively communicate educational material through interactive elements. Visual graphics will help a user to comprehend the information in different ways throughout the experience.

Project Overview

Target Device:

The target device for this website would be a laptop or tablet. These devices will be able to process the assets quicker while the larger, landscape style screen will allow for a better user experience.

Use Cases & Environment:

This website can be used in many different ways. If a user is looking to purchase a snake themselves but is just starting out in the hobby, this site would be an effective at home use for research before a purchase.

Another at home use would be simply for people looking for information on snakes. This could be seen in trying to find factual information about snakes or just individual research.

This website could also be used in an educational setting such as a classroom. Educators could use this site to teach about these snake species or about general information about snakes.

Research

Research

Content Research Sources:

https://www.britannica.com/animal/snake

https://www.havahart.com/snake-facts?srsltid=ARcRdnoy339DWG62yKgKQBggnQ0cZdXaGslj4II-DIW6nX6wB-IHg07w

https://www.tampavet.com/exotics-blog/best-beginner-snakes/

https://www.youtube.com/@ClintsReptiles

https://cornsnake.net/pages/corn-snake-morph-photos

https://www.creaturecarecards.com/cornsnake.html

Google Docs Research Page

Competitive Analysis

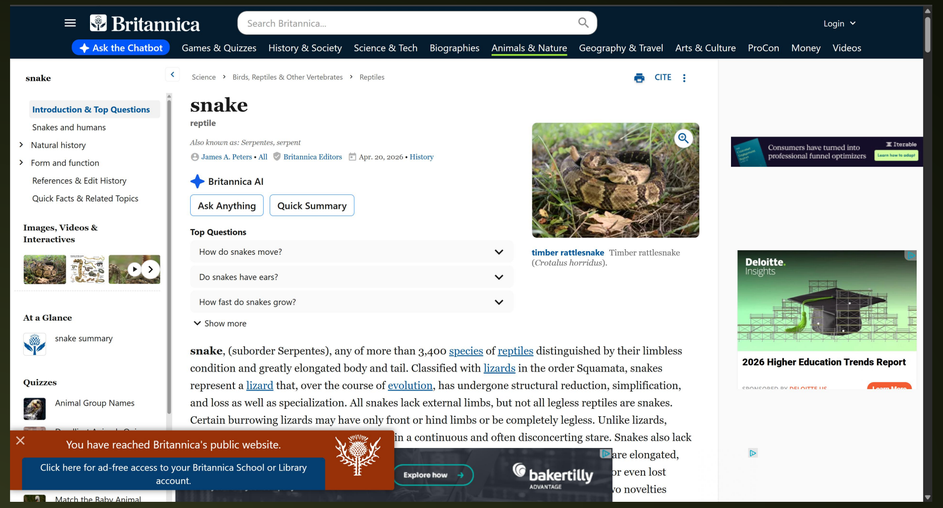
Britannica.com:

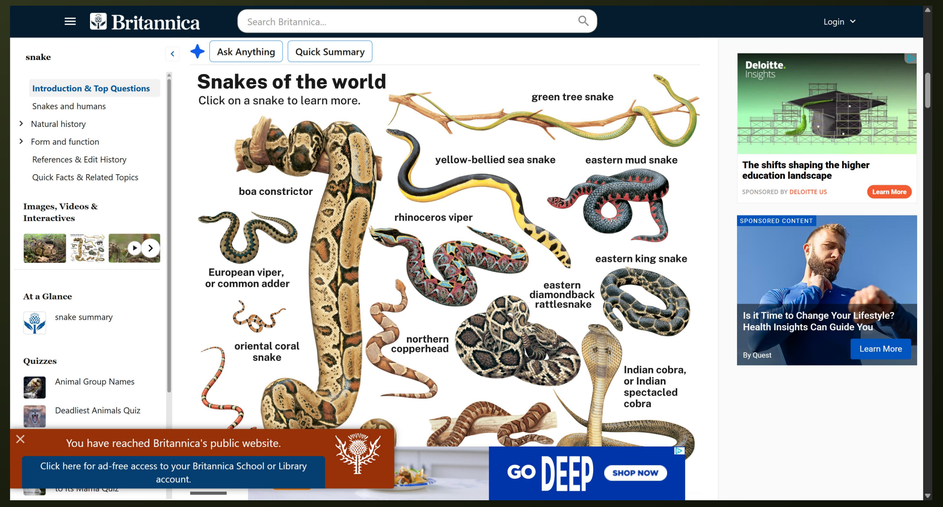
https://www.britannica.com/animal/snake

Websites like Britannica.com are very educational for users, but they lack in intractability and engagement. As seen in these images of their website about snakes, they have lengthy paragraphs of information which can appear boring to a user.

The site does provide a “Top Questions” section which can be helpful for some users who don’t want to read through the whole site. Another useful tool on this site is the “Snakes of the world” chart. A user can click on each snake to learn more about them, but yet again it leads to paragraphs of information.

My takeaways from this site are to focus on maintaining a way for users to stay engaged while reading bits of information rather than large chunks. Like their top questions section, small bits of commonly asked information should be made easily avalible to the user.



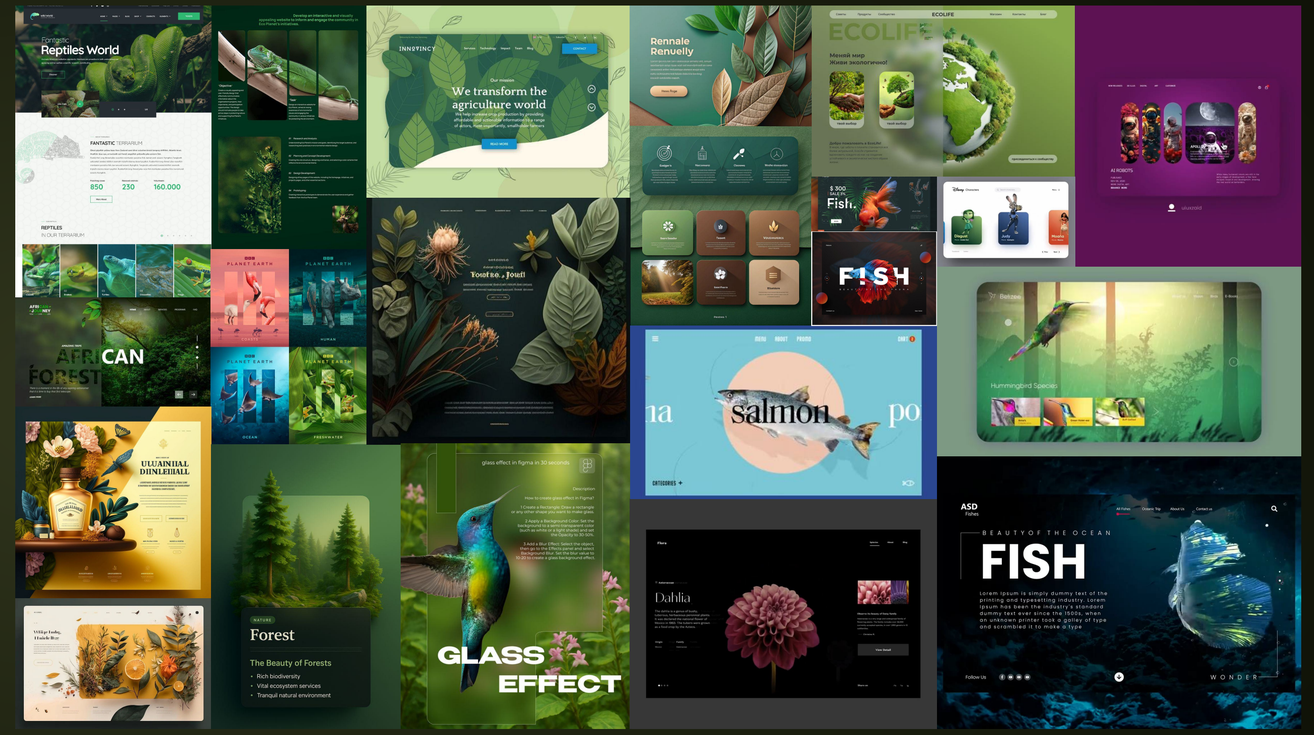


UX Trend Research

I looked into UX trends in more modern styled educational and nature themed websites.

Common Trends:

- Combination of 2D and 3D or video assets
- Navigation with 3-5 links and no container
- Bold san serif fonts
- Either solid background or 2D illustration or photo background
- Minimal text with interactive elements to interact with the assets or information



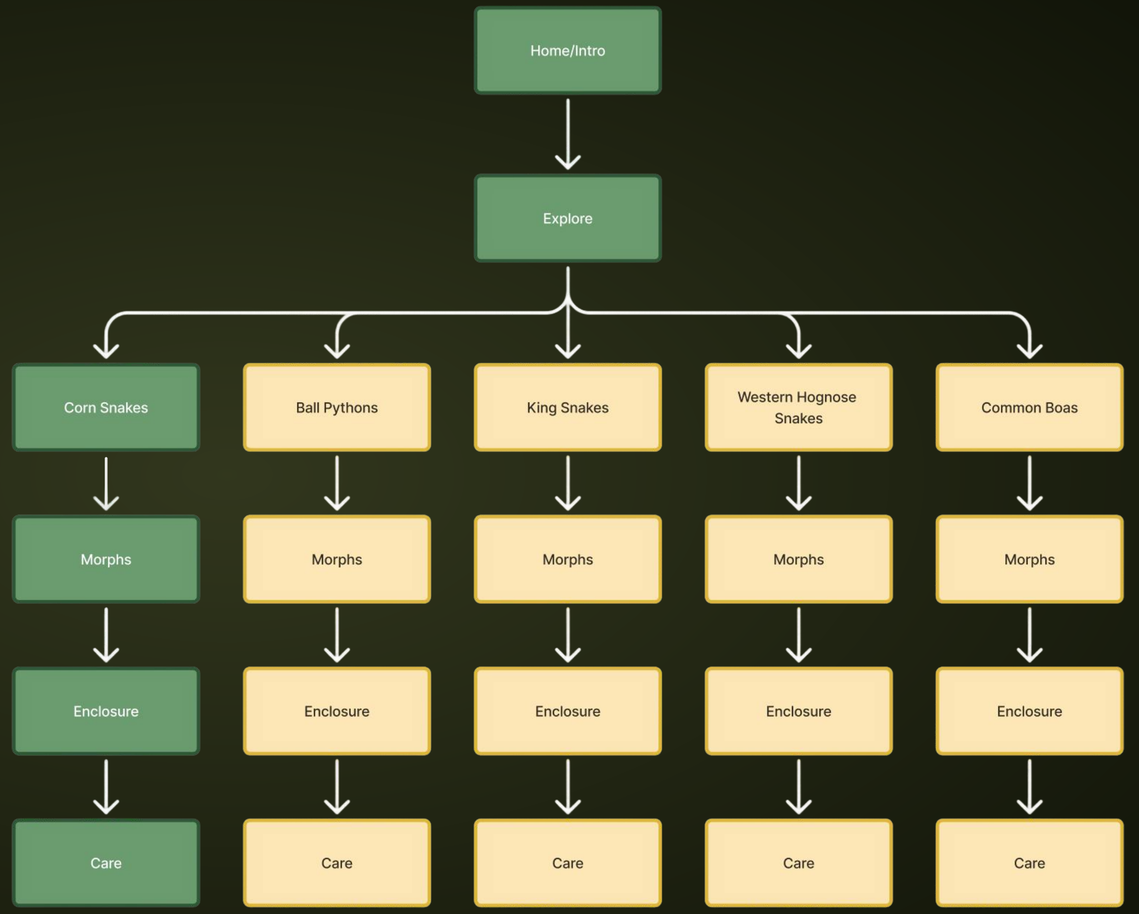
Planning

Site Map

The user would start at the home/splash screen then on tap enter the explore section of the site.

After choosing a snake from the explore section, the user can then interact with the overview of then snake.

Then the user can select to learn more or go back to the explore page. If the user wants to learn more they can navigate through three pages, morphs, enclosure, and care.



Sketches

Quick sketches of concept illustration and layouts.

1 **3D Enclosure Diagram**

A 3D interactive diagram explaining different parts of a standard snake enclosure.

2 **Home Screen**

A 3D animated diagram with intro text.

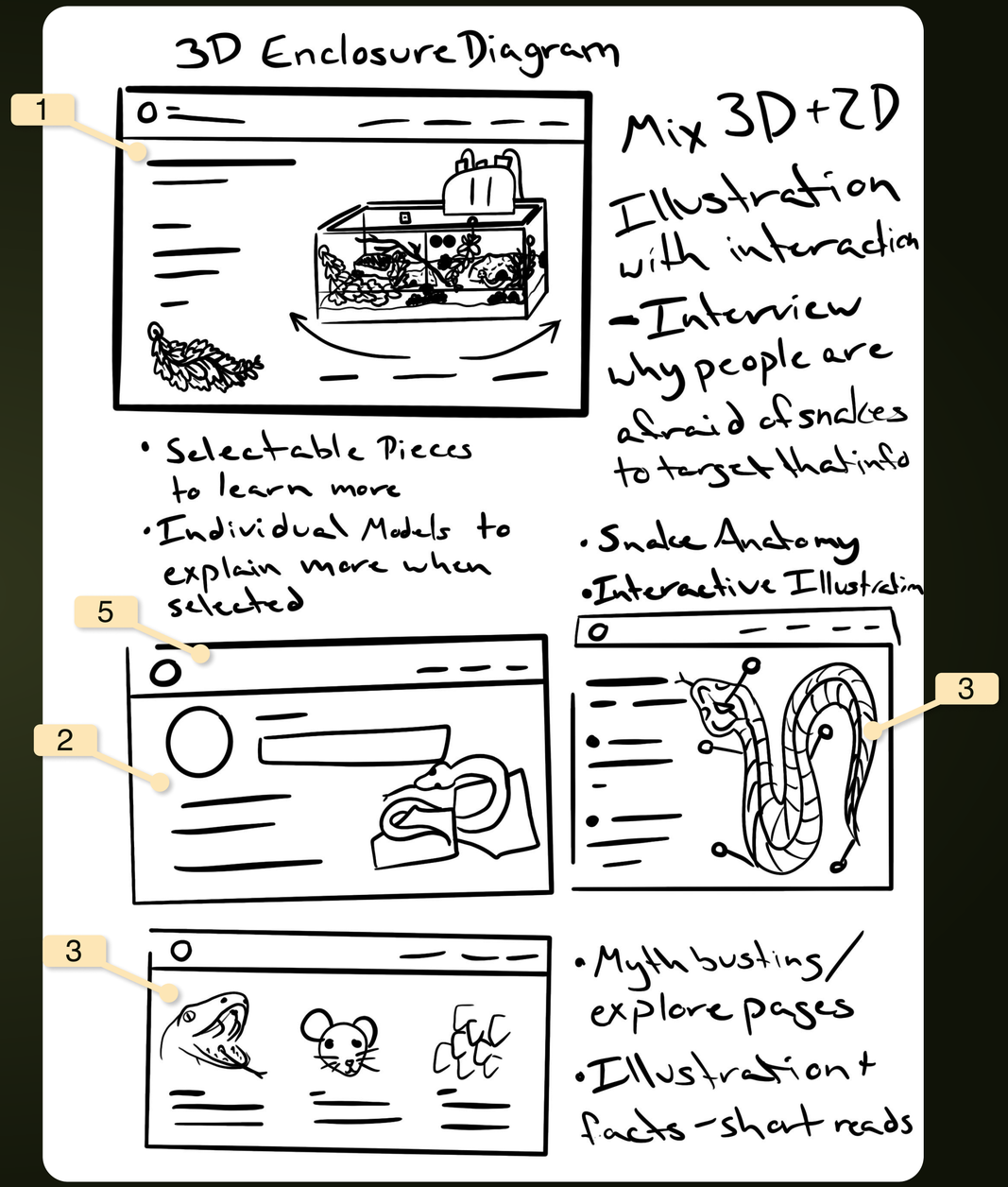
3 **Myth Busting**

Interactive sections with illustration and short readings on the information.

4 **Anatomy Diagram**

An interactive diagram with different parts of the snake.

5 **Navigation**



Sketches

Quick sketches of concept illustration and layouts.

1 Household Snakes

Information and illustrations on common pet snakes.
Interactive morph buttons to see color changes.

2 Facts

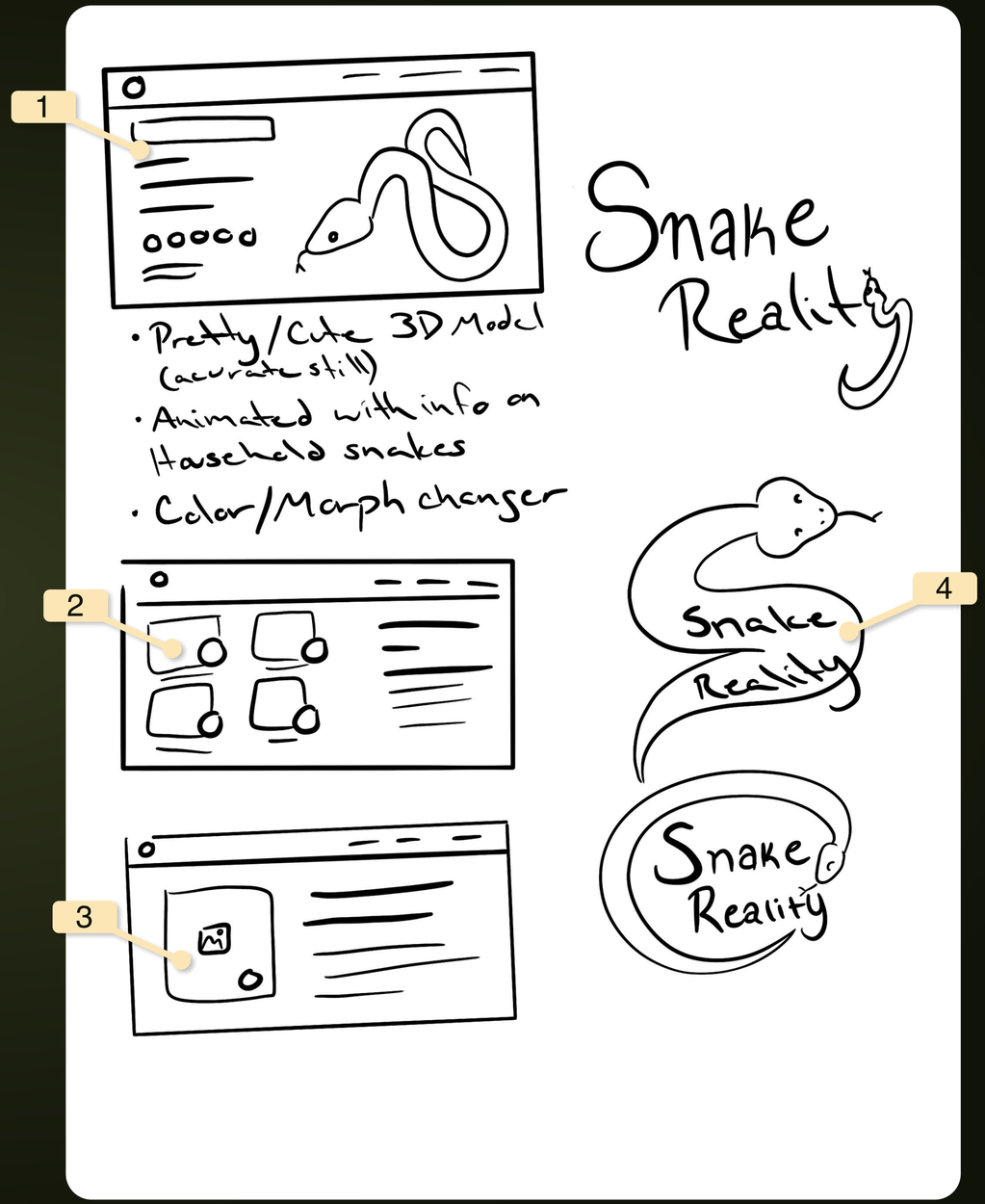
Expandable facts.

3 Facts Screen 2

Expanded facts with more information.

4 Logos

Logo iterations.



Grid Layout

Screen Size:

1536 x 825 px

I had originally started with screen dimensions of 1900 x 1200 px to fit a dell xps 17 screen size, but I switched to 1536 x 825 px to fit a browser size instead.

Grid:

12 Columns: 80px Margin, 20px Gutter

Rows: Auto, 4px Height, 40px Top Offset, 4px Gutter

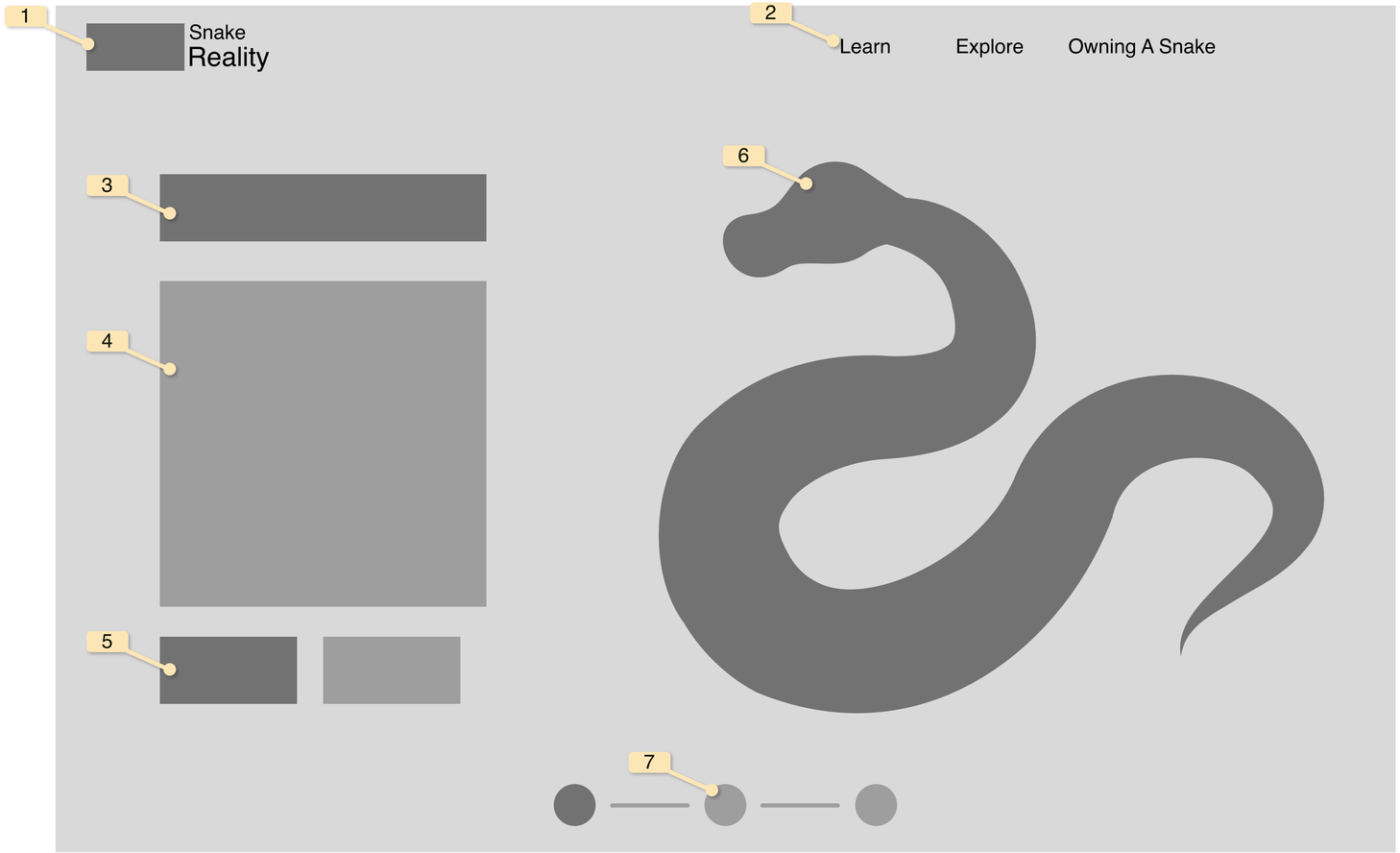
Wireframes

Lo-Fi Wireframes

SNAKE BASICS

This page introduces the user to what a snake is.

1. Logo
2. Nav Options
3. Title Text
4. Body Text
5. Buttons
6. Snake Imagery
7. Progression Indicator



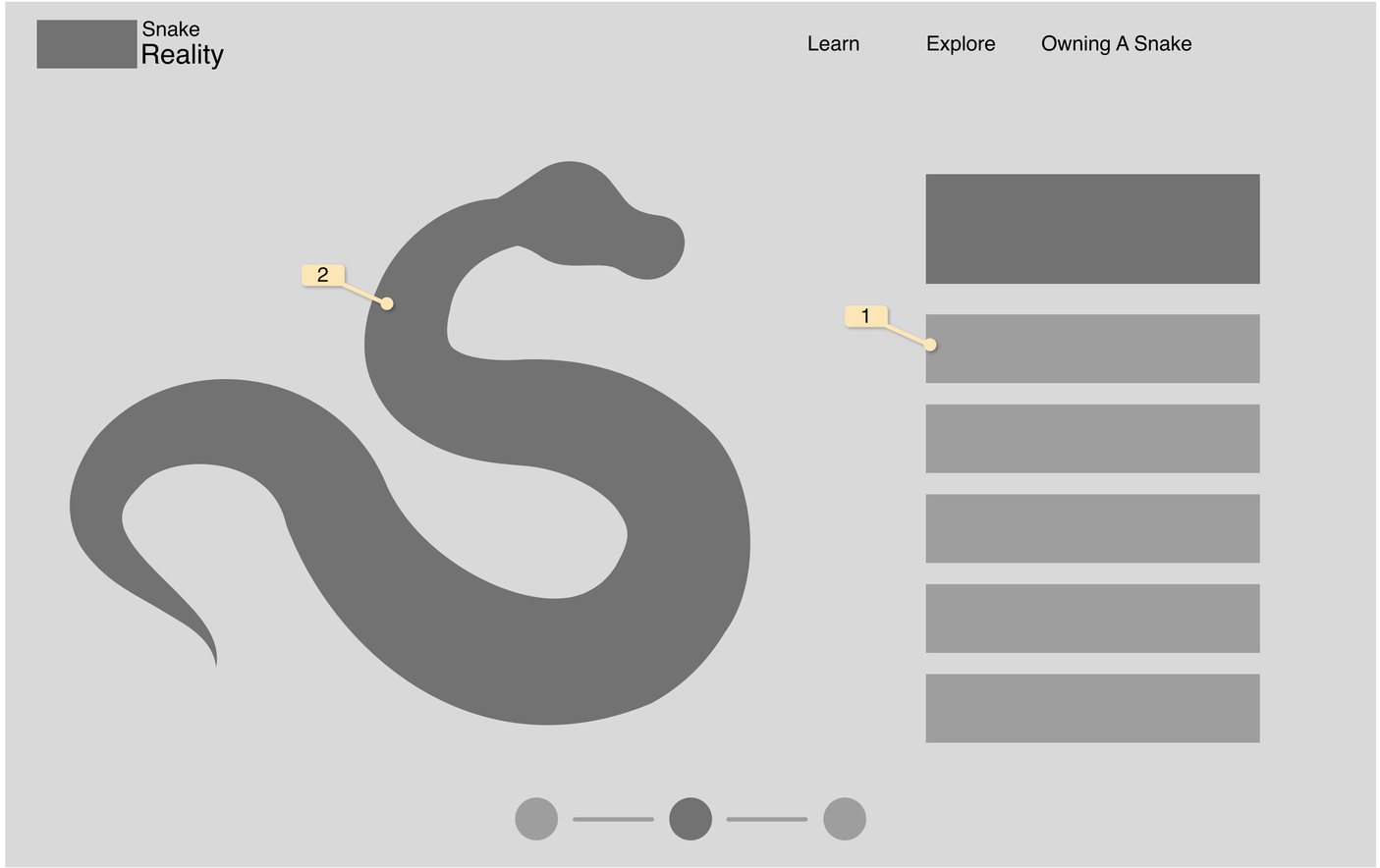
Lo-Fi Wireframes

SNAKE FACTS

This allows users to explore facts about snakes.

1 Expandable Text

2 Snake Animation from First Screen

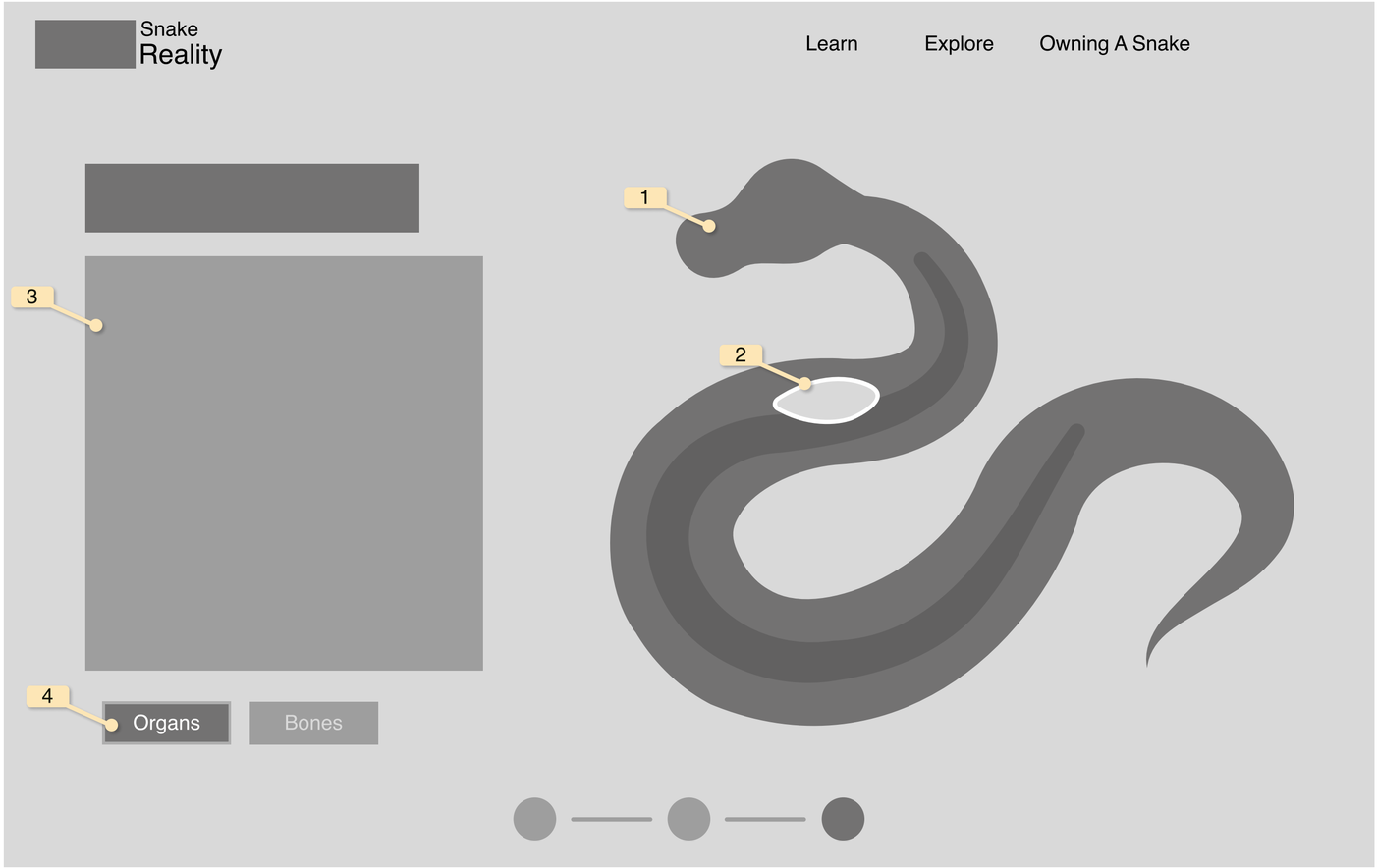


Lo-Fi Wireframes

ANATOMY OF A SNAKE

Interactive Anatomy Diagram

1. Interactive Anatomy Diagram
2. Highlighted Organ
3. Text About Selected Organ
4. Buttons to Change Diagram



Lo-Fi Wireframes

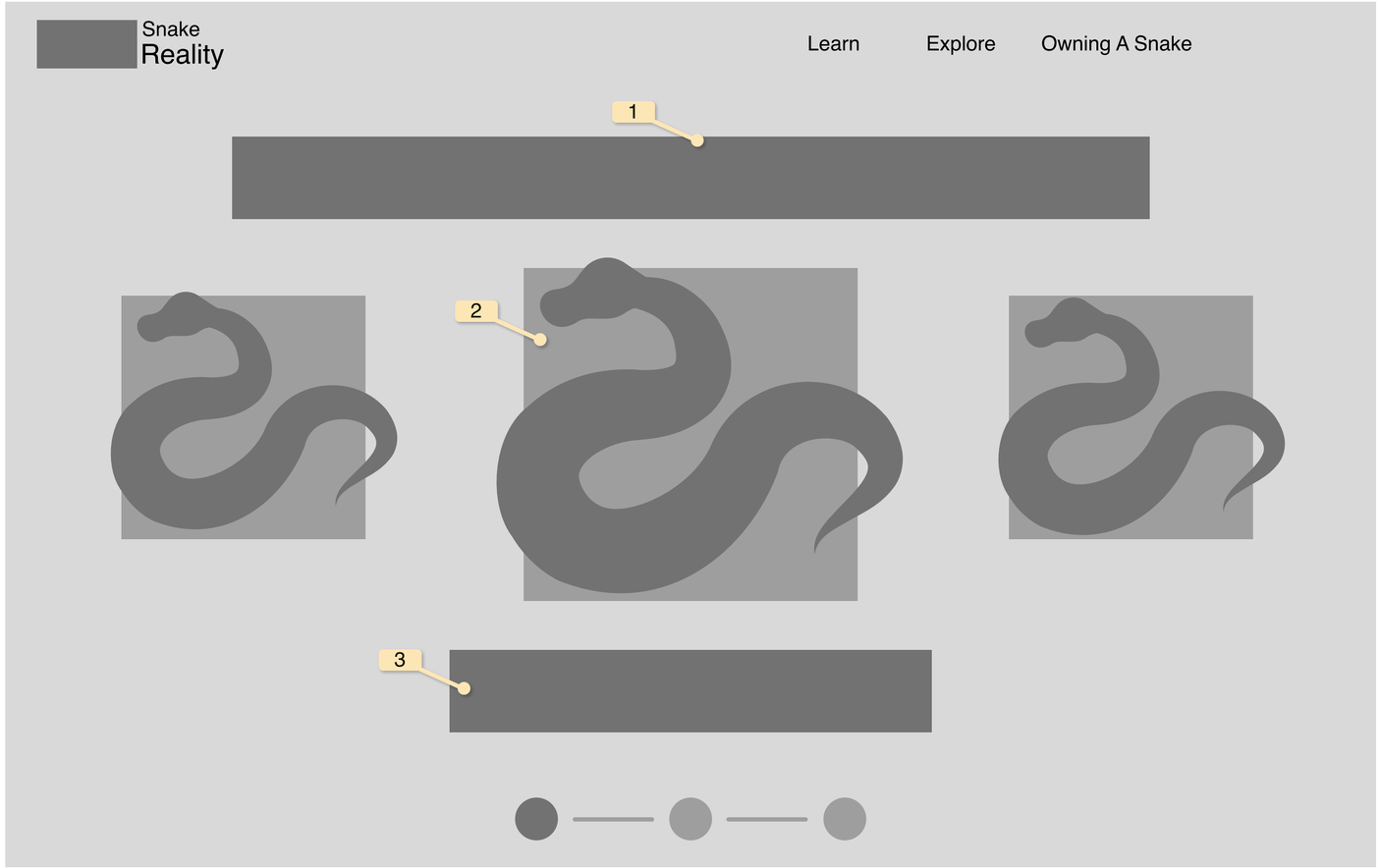
HOUSEHOLD SNAKES

Carousel Selection of Snakes

1 Header/ Directions

2 Snake Type

3 Snake Name



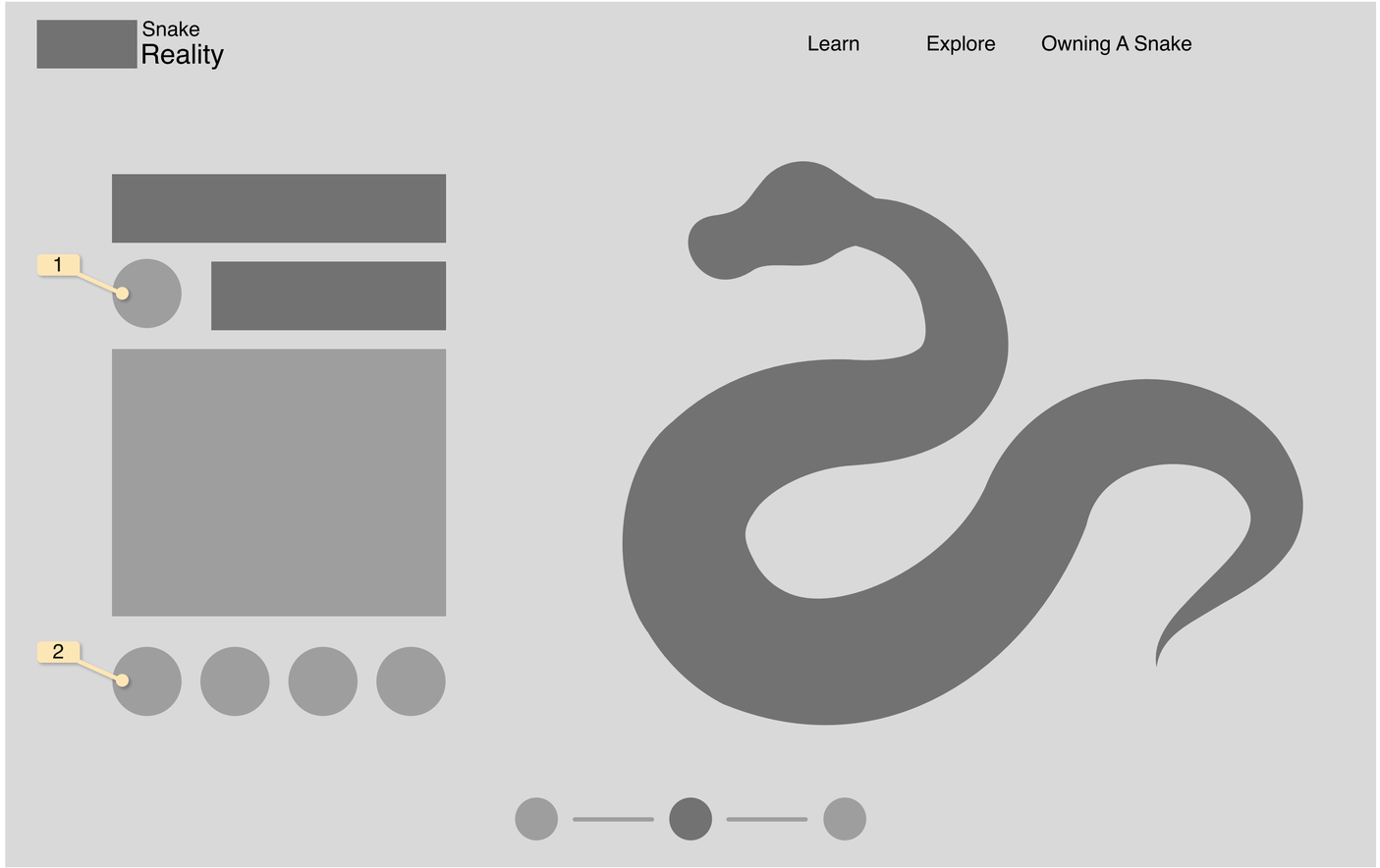
Lo-Fi Wireframes

INFORMATION ON SNAKE SPECIES

Information on a particular species and color morphs.

1 Care Ranking

2 Snake Morph Buttons



Lo-Fi Wireframes

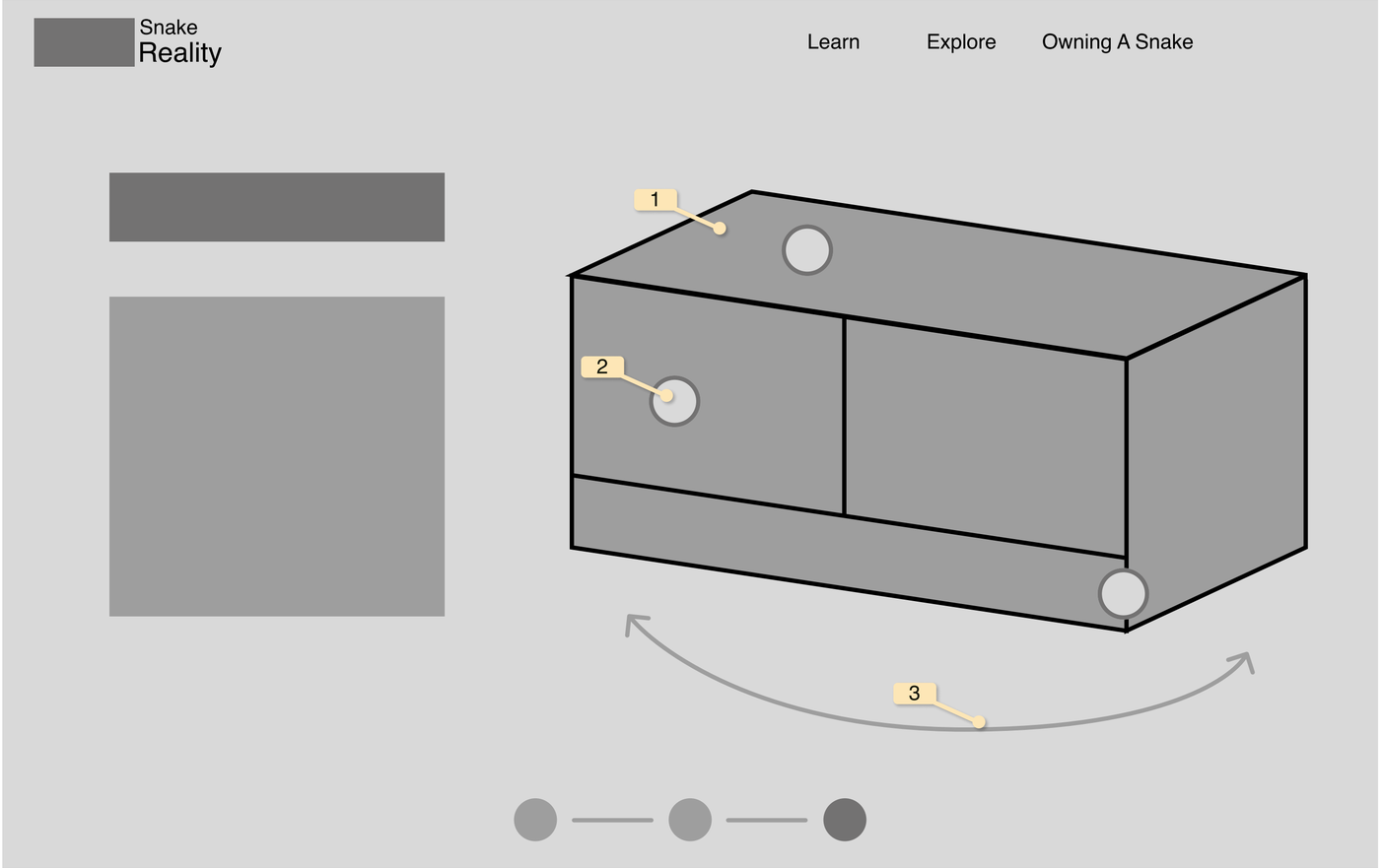
ENCLOSURE DIAGRAM

Interactive Enclosure Information

1 Tank Interactive 3D Model

2 Interactive Points

3 Rotation Indicator

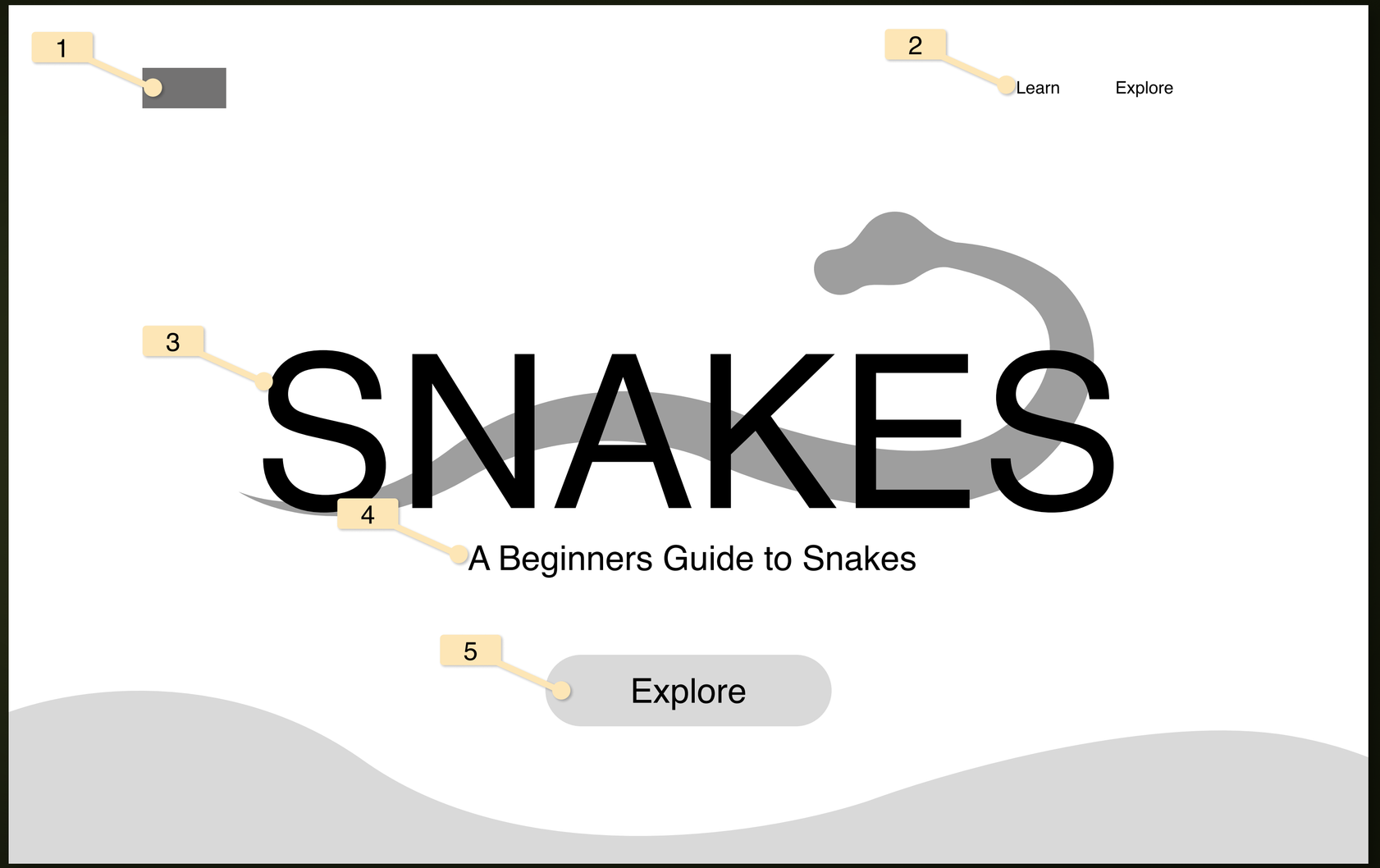


Hi-Fi Wireframes

TITLE SCREEN

This page shows the title of the site with a short description.

1. Logo
2. Nav Options
3. Title Text
4. Body Text
5. Explore Button



Hi-Fi Wireframes

SNAKE 1 - CORN SNAKES

Gives information about snakes and allows user to learn more about this species.

1. Snake Name
2. Brief Description of Snake
3. Learn More Button - Next User Flow
4. Scroll Indicator
5. 3D Model of Snake
6. Interactive Facts - Indicators

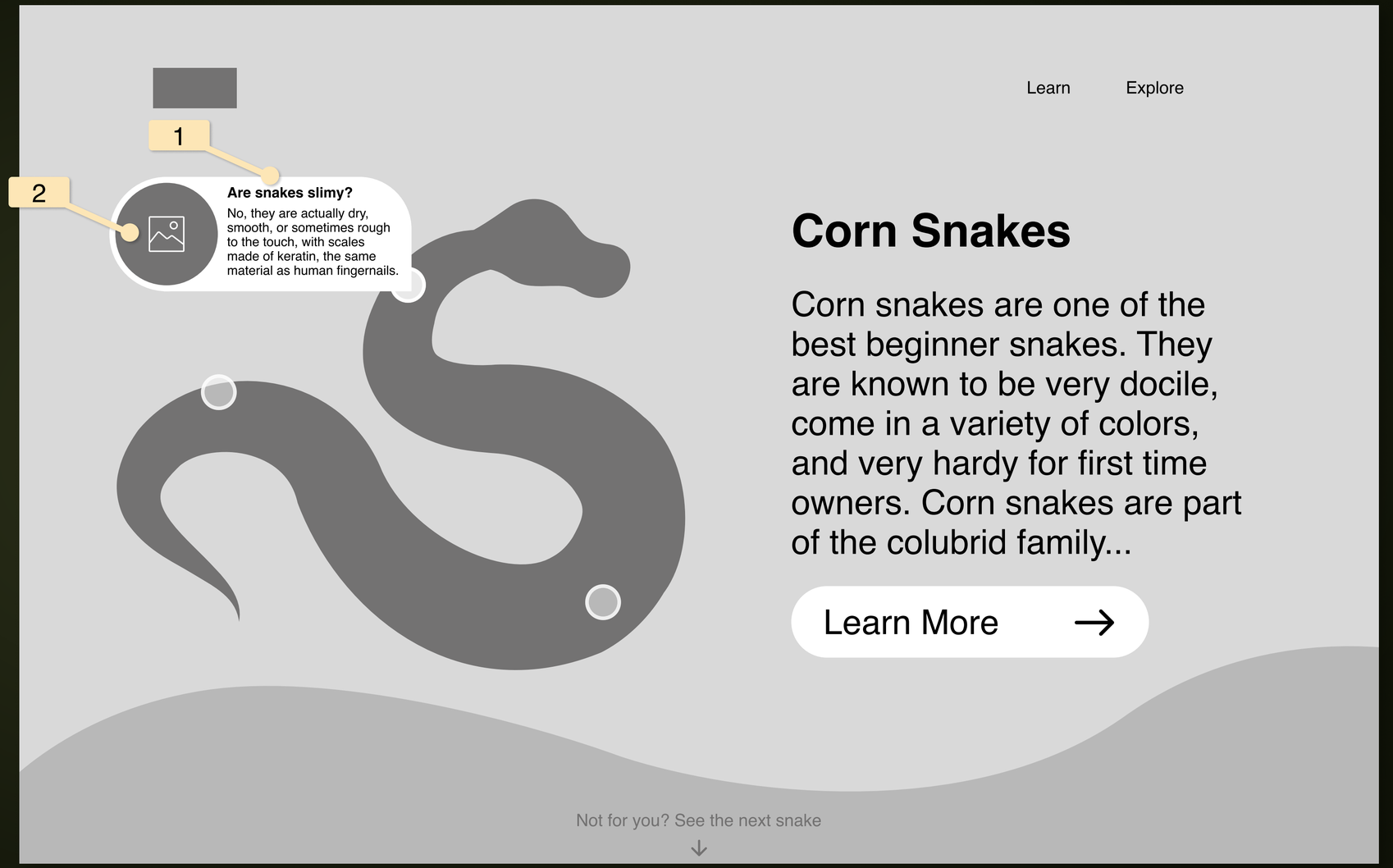
Hi-Fi Wireframes

SNAKE 1 - CORN SNAKE FACTS

Pop-up interactive facts

1 Snake Fact Pop-up

2 Image Relating to Fact

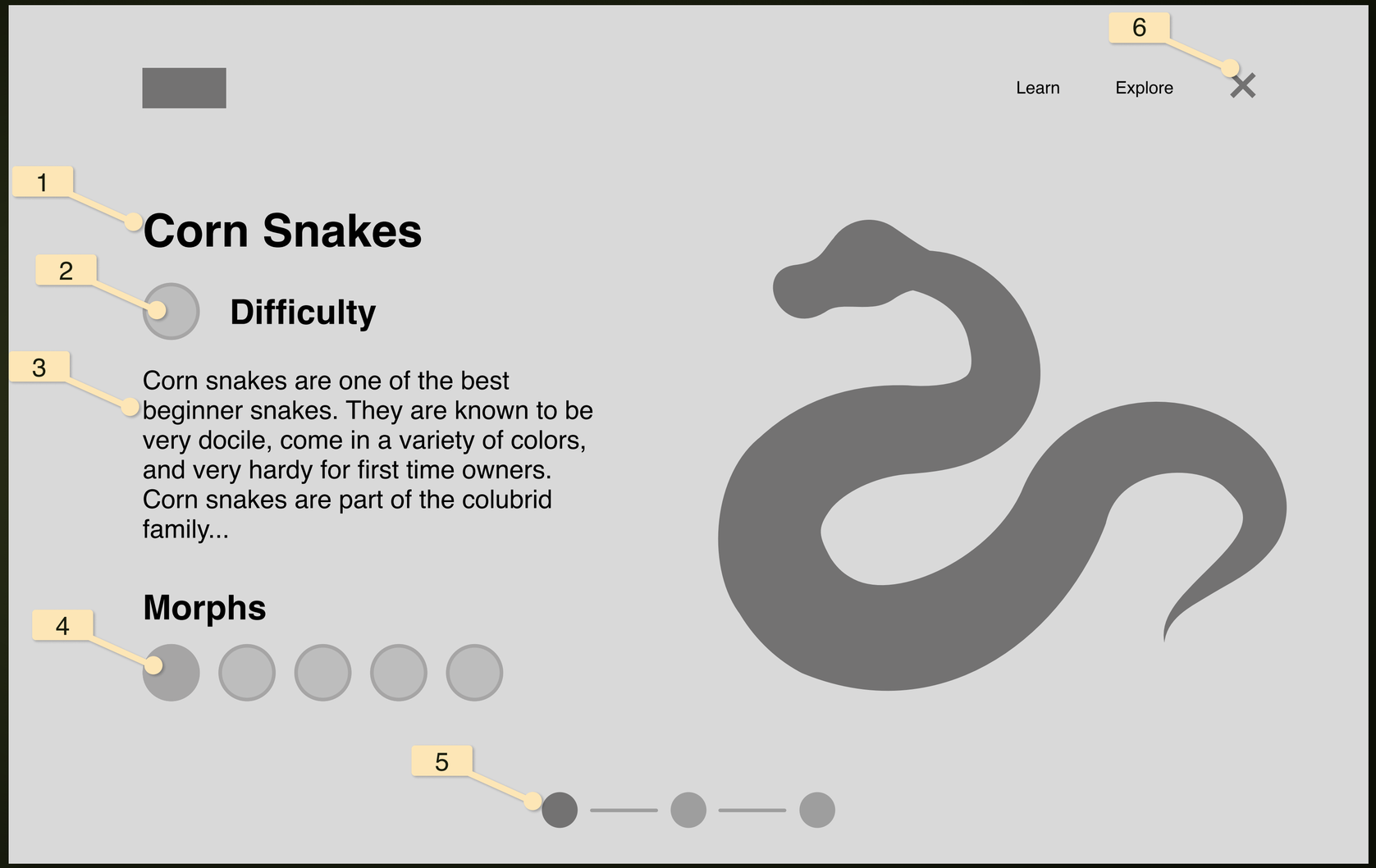


Hi-Fi Wireframes

SNAKE 1 - START

Starting care guide / facts of this type of snake.

1. Snake Type
2. Difficulty of Care Rating
3. Description
4. Morph Buttons - Change Snake Images
5. Progress Bar
6. Exit Button

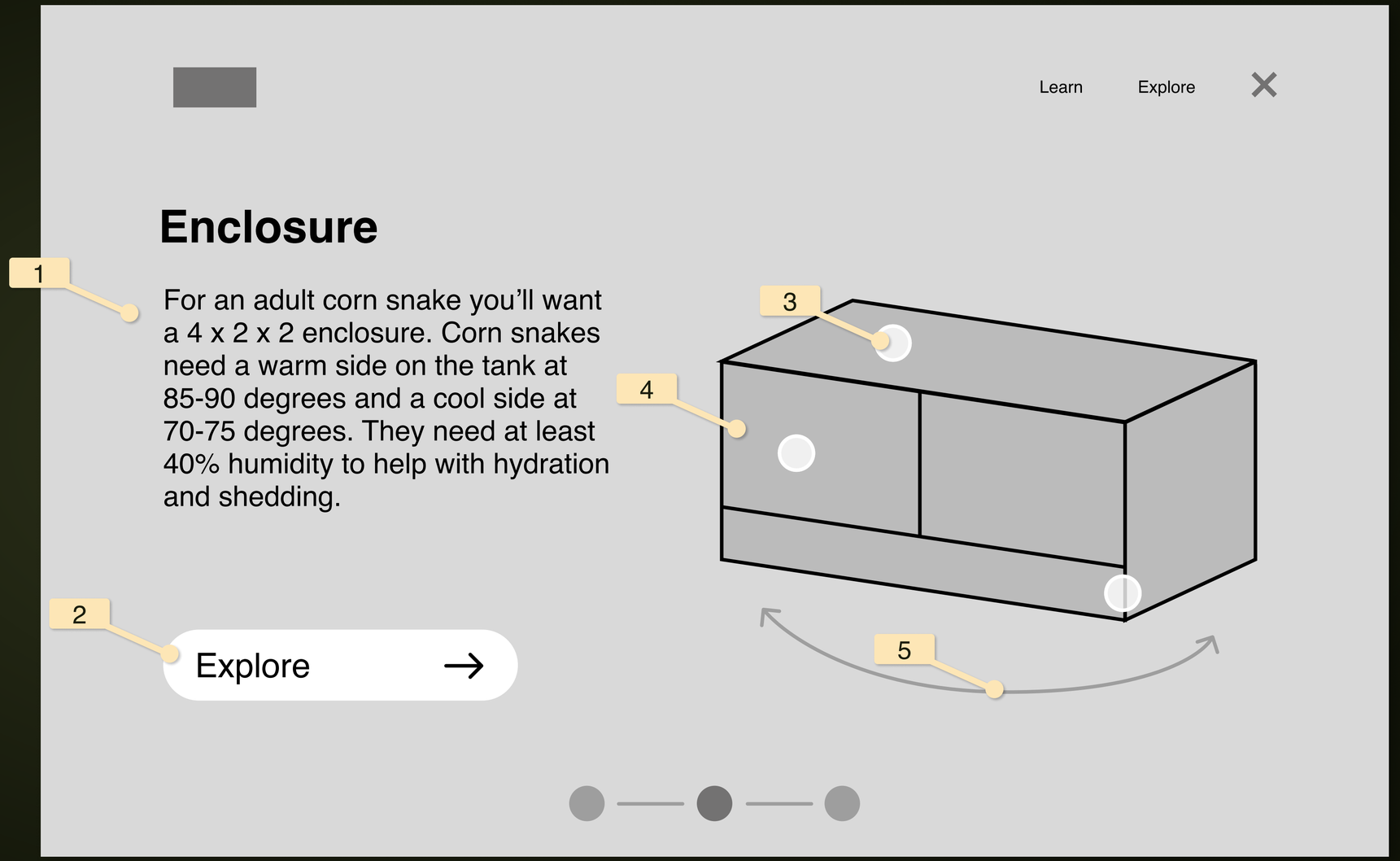


Hi-Fi Wireframes

SNAKE ENCLOSURE

Information on enclosures for snake 1.

1. Description
2. Explore Button - Starts Interaction
3. Interactive Parts of Enclosure
4. 3D Model
5. Rotation Indicator

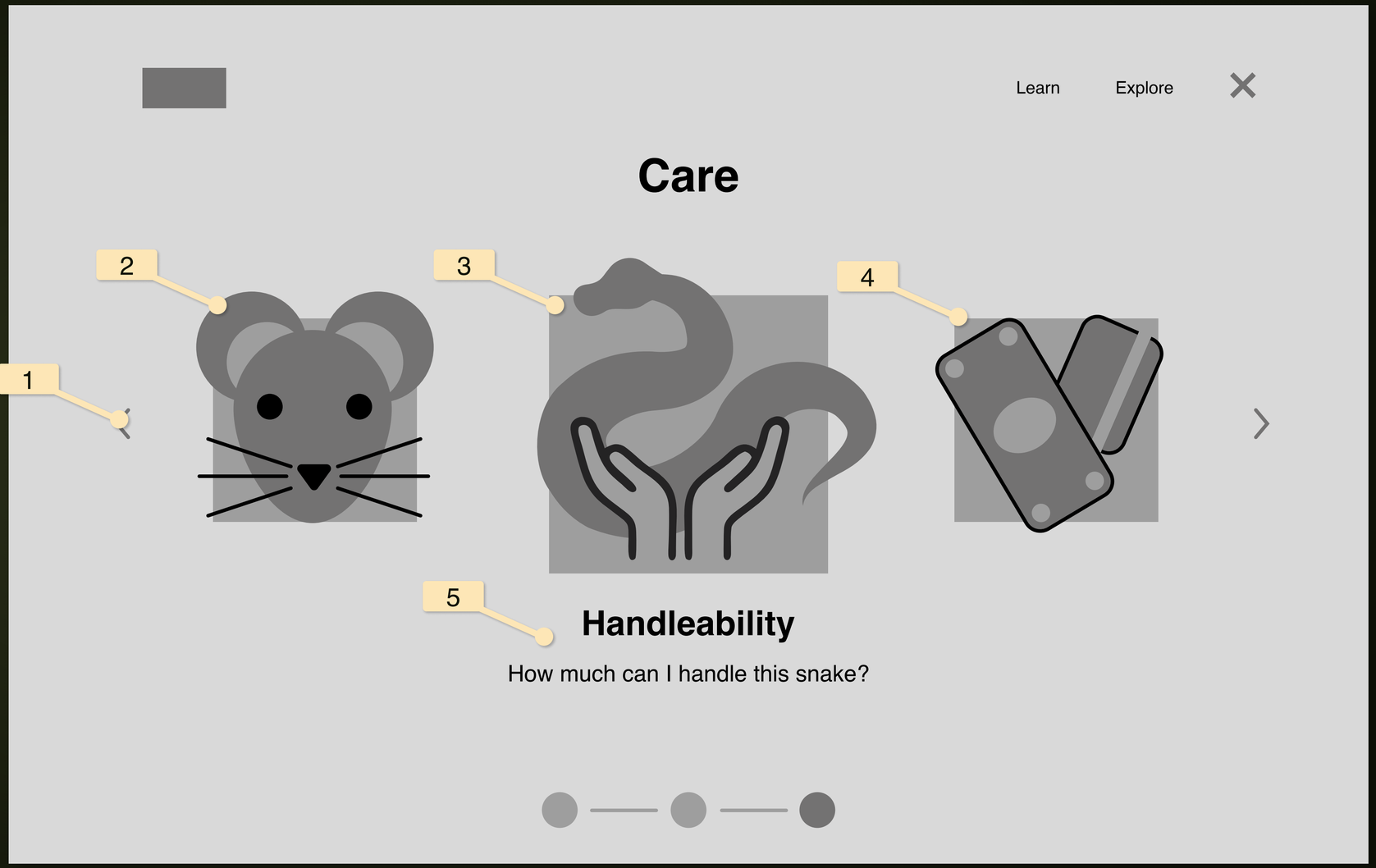


Hi-Fi Wireframes

CARE

Care for Snake 1 - Options

1. Carousel Indicator
2. Feeding
3. Handleability
4. Cost / Availability
5. Title and Description

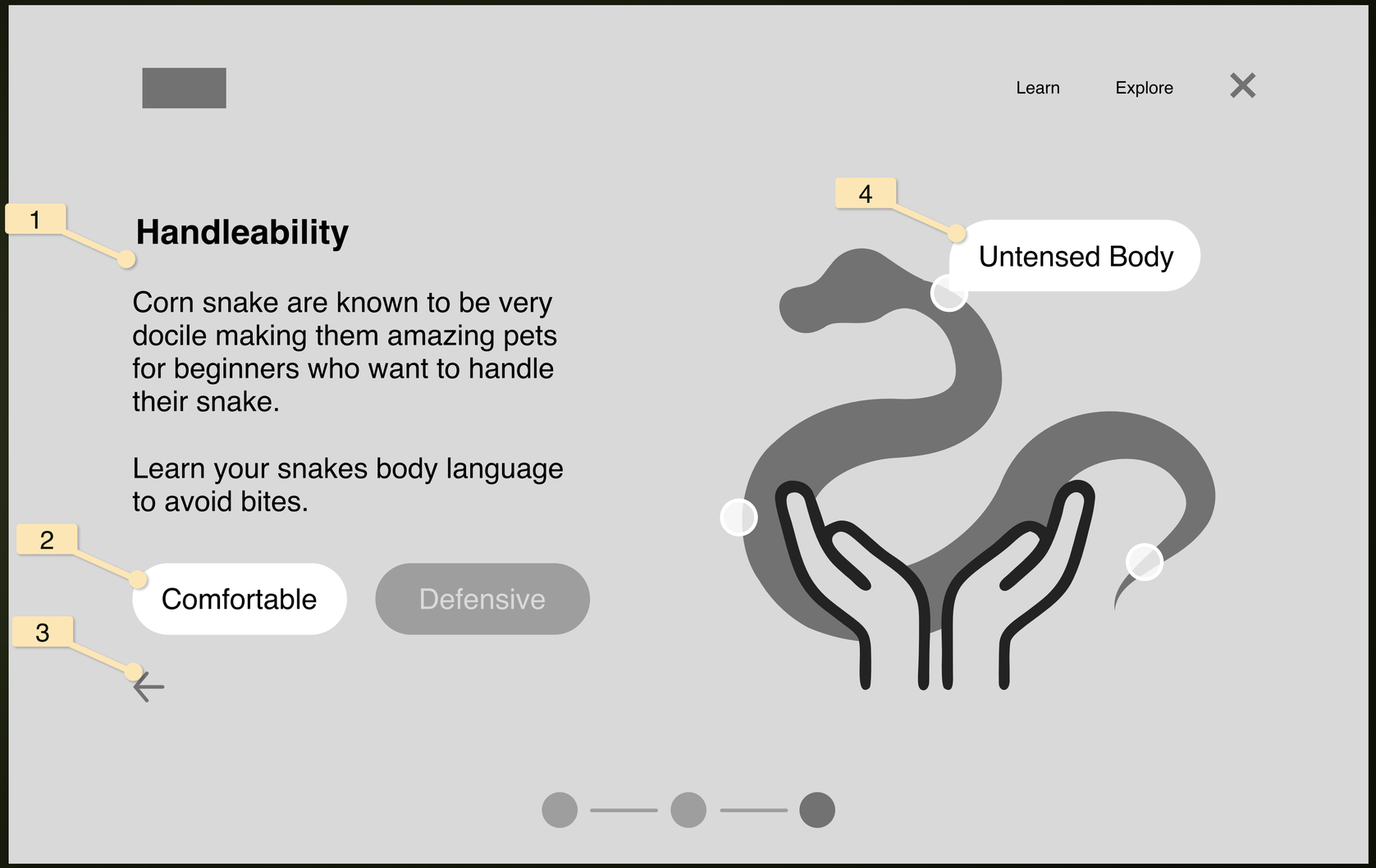


Hi-Fi Wireframes

HANDLEABILITY

Handleability of Snake 1 - Body language diagram

1. Title and Description
2. Radio Buttons - Change Snake Behavior
3. Back Button to Carousel
4. Interactive Indicators - Snake Behavior

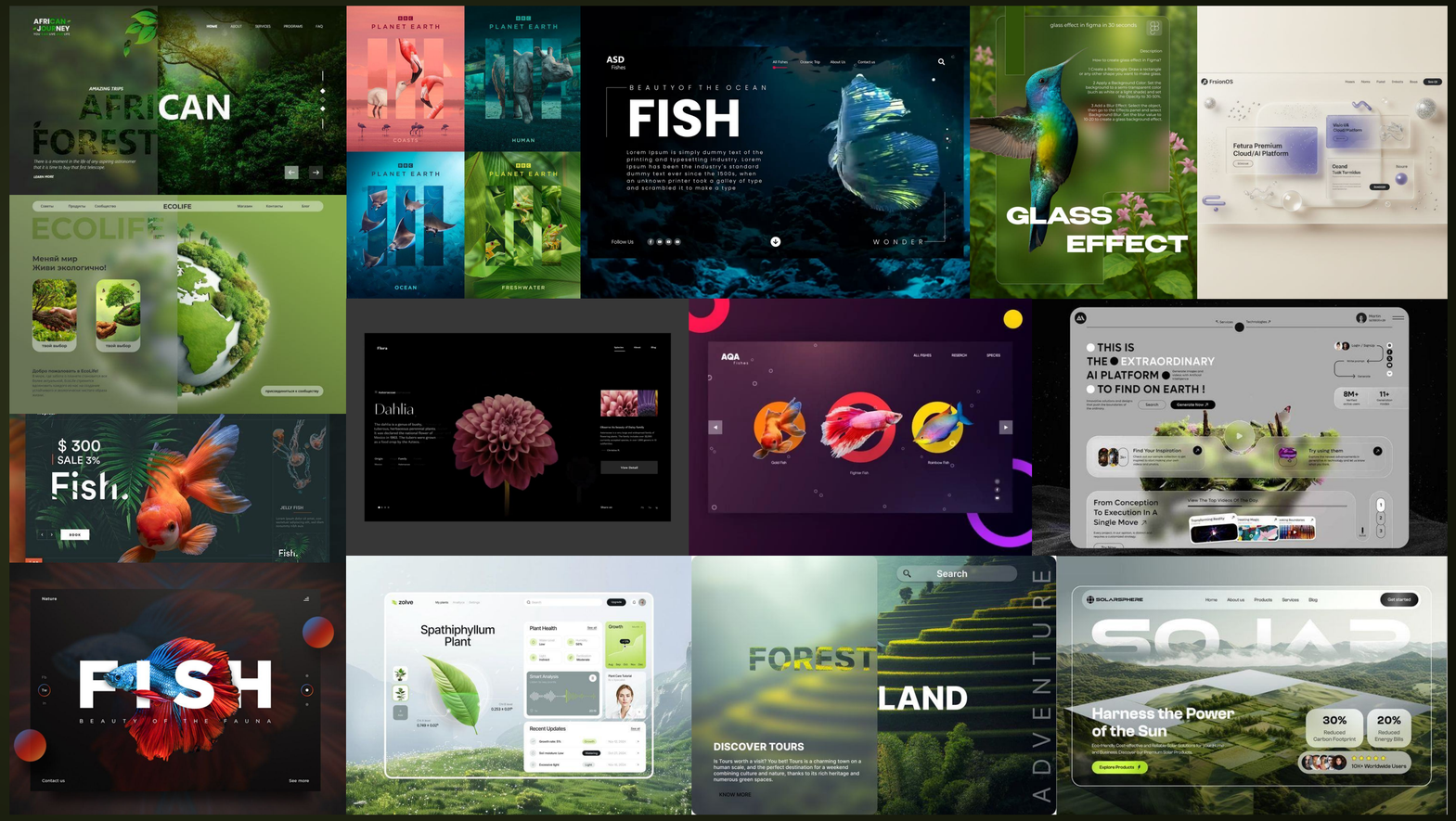


Style Exploration

Style 1

Glass:

This style consists of 3D models overlaid with glass effects to store 2D information.



Style 1 - Compositions

Glass:

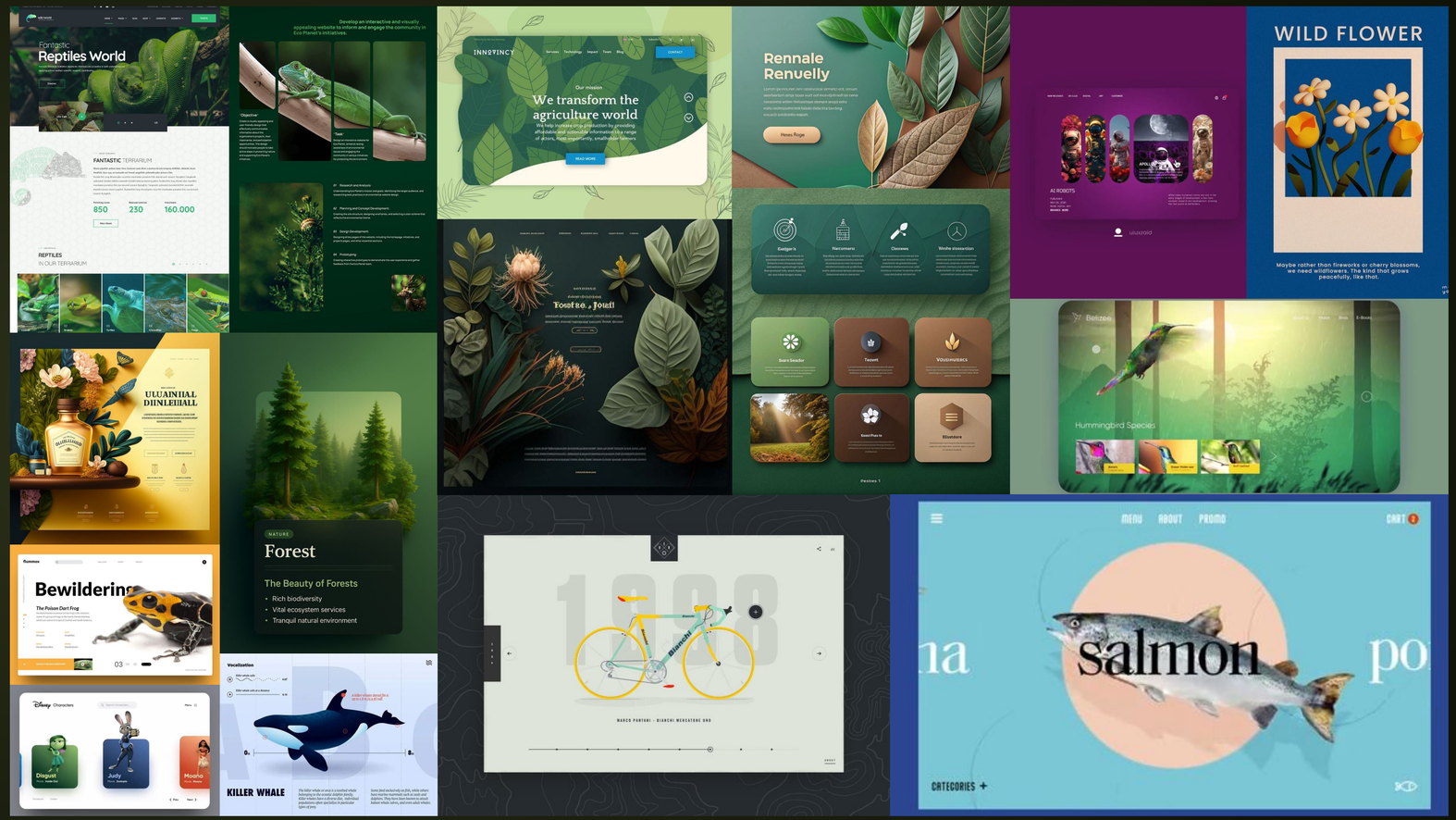
This style consists of 3D models overlaid with glass effects to store 2D information.

I chose not to use this style as the detailed background competed with the visual assets and text taking away their importance.

Style 2

2D + 3D:

This style consists a 3D model centered design around 2D assets and backgrounds.



Style 2 - Compositions

2D + 3D:

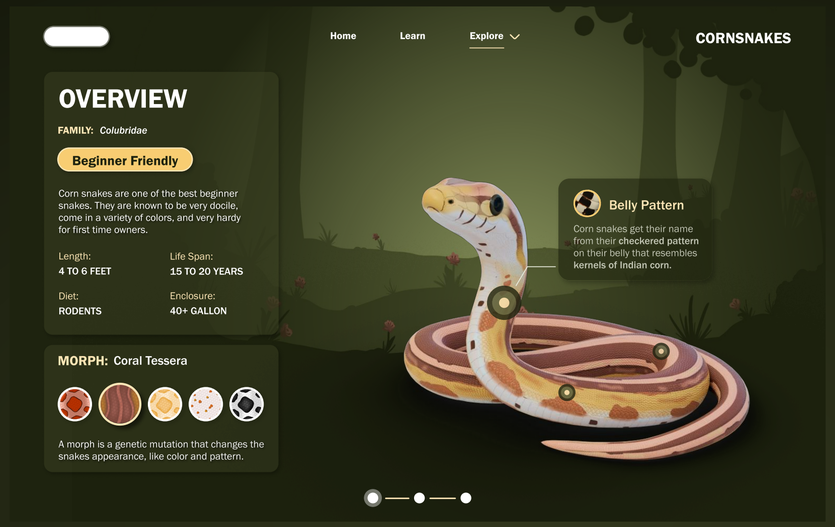
This style consists a 3D model centered design around 2D assets and backgrounds.

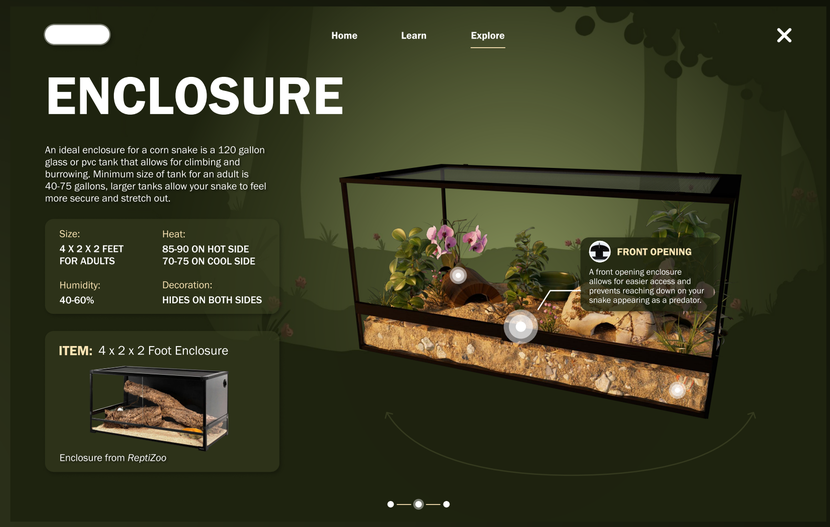
I chose to continue with this style as it gave much more importance to the text and the 3D assets.

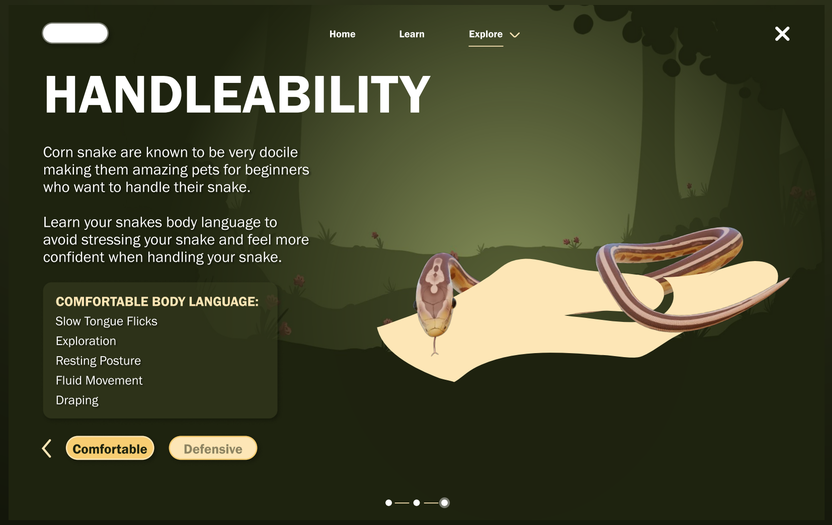
Iterations

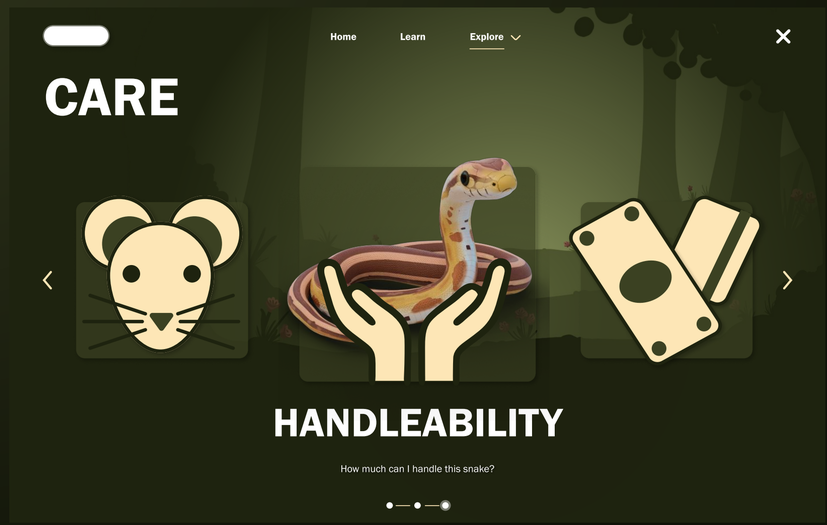
Iteration 1

In this first iteration I struggled to find balance between the text and background elements. The text also took away from the main assets. There was no clear level of importance here.







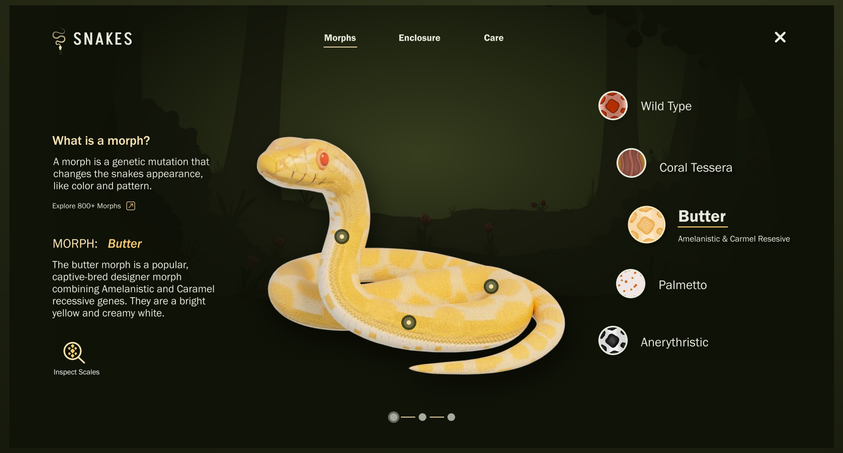


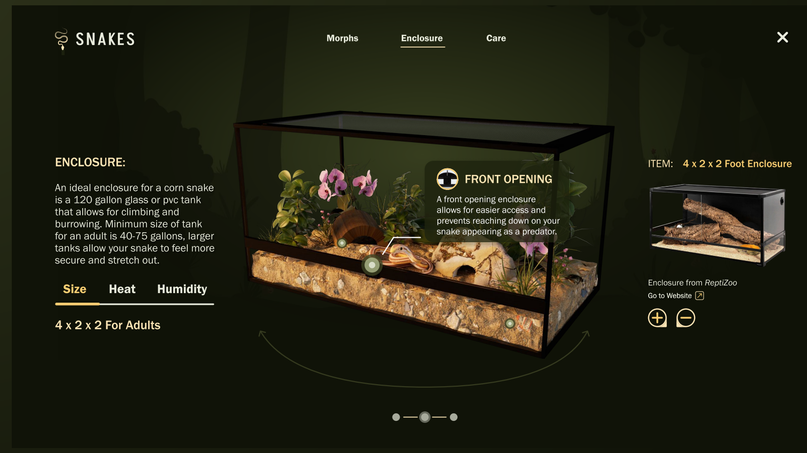
Iteration 2

In this iteration, I tried splitting the information to surround the main assets but they still seemed to significantly take away from the main assets.

Iteration 3

In this iteration, darkening the background gave more contrast to the main assets. Splitting the information and decreasing how much space they took up improved the hierarchy but some assets still fought against each other.





Asset Creation

3D assets like the snakes were sculpted in zbrush then textured in adobe substance painter and finally render and positioned in cinema 4D. The enclosure was entirely made in cinema 4D and other assets like the background were made in procreate.

Final Solution

UI Style Board

Color Palette:

#101308 #1E230E #E9ECDD #FDE6B6 #F8CD72

Typography:

Header 1
Akshar Bold 48pt

Header 2
Franklin Gothic Demi 24pt

Body
Franklin Gothic Book 20pt

BUTTONS
Franklin Gothic Book 16pt

Logo:

SNAKES

Buttons:

LEARN MORE LEARN MORE

Iconography:

Main Assets:

Final Compositions

Splash Screen:

Here is where the user starts. Once they tap the screen the user enters the enclosure to select a snake.

Final Compositions

Explore:

This is where the user can navigate to different snakes inside the enclosure to select one to learn more about it.

Final Compositions

Corn Snake Overview:

After selecting the corn snake, users can learn facts about this type of snake and choose to continue learning about them or return to exploring the enclosure.

Final Compositions

Morphs:

On this page, users can learn about corn snake morphs and change the morph along with the facts about each variation.

Final Compositions

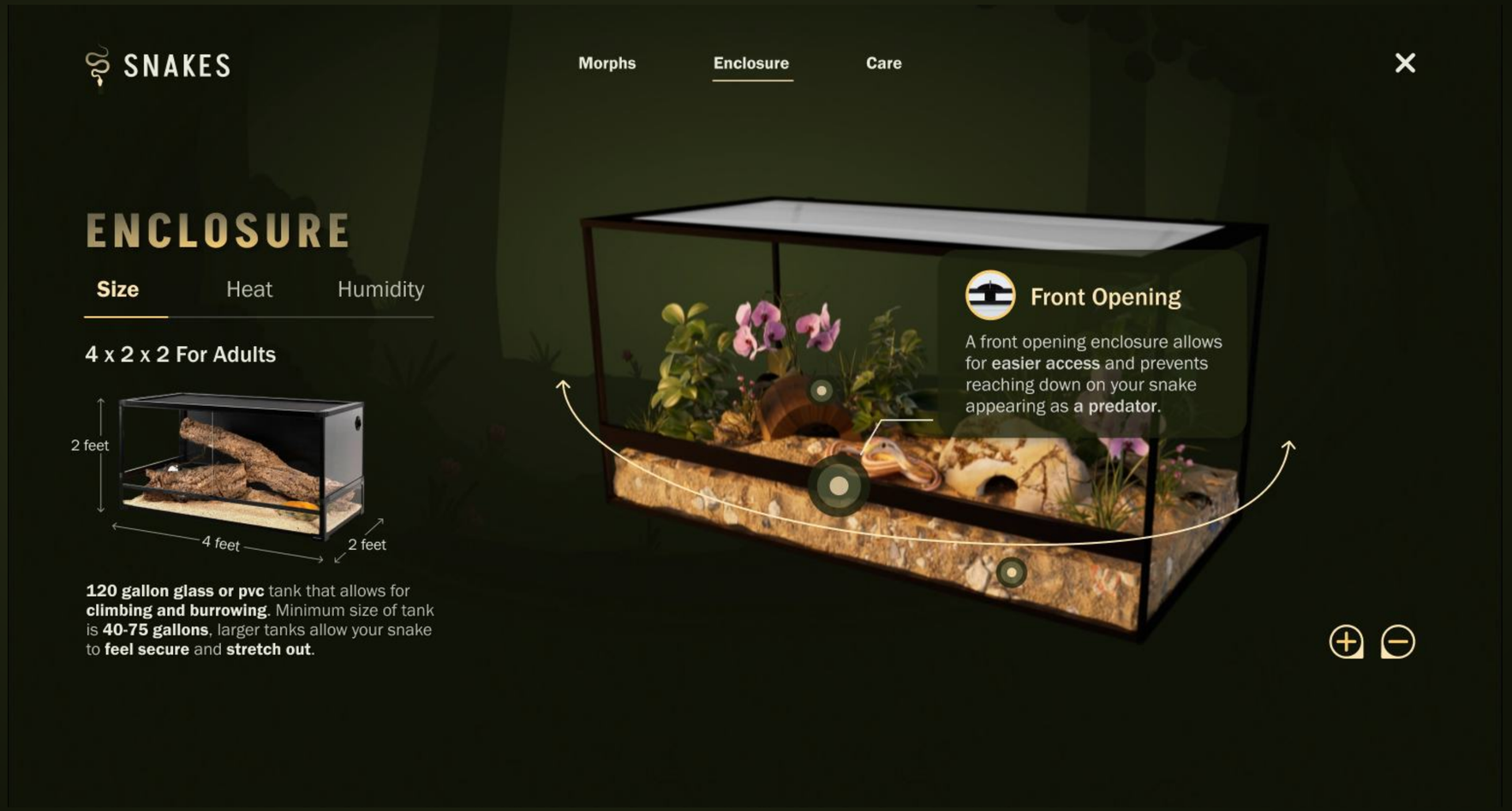
Morphs:

When a user changes the morphs the hot spots will change along with the description and visual of the snake.

Final Compositions

Enclosure:

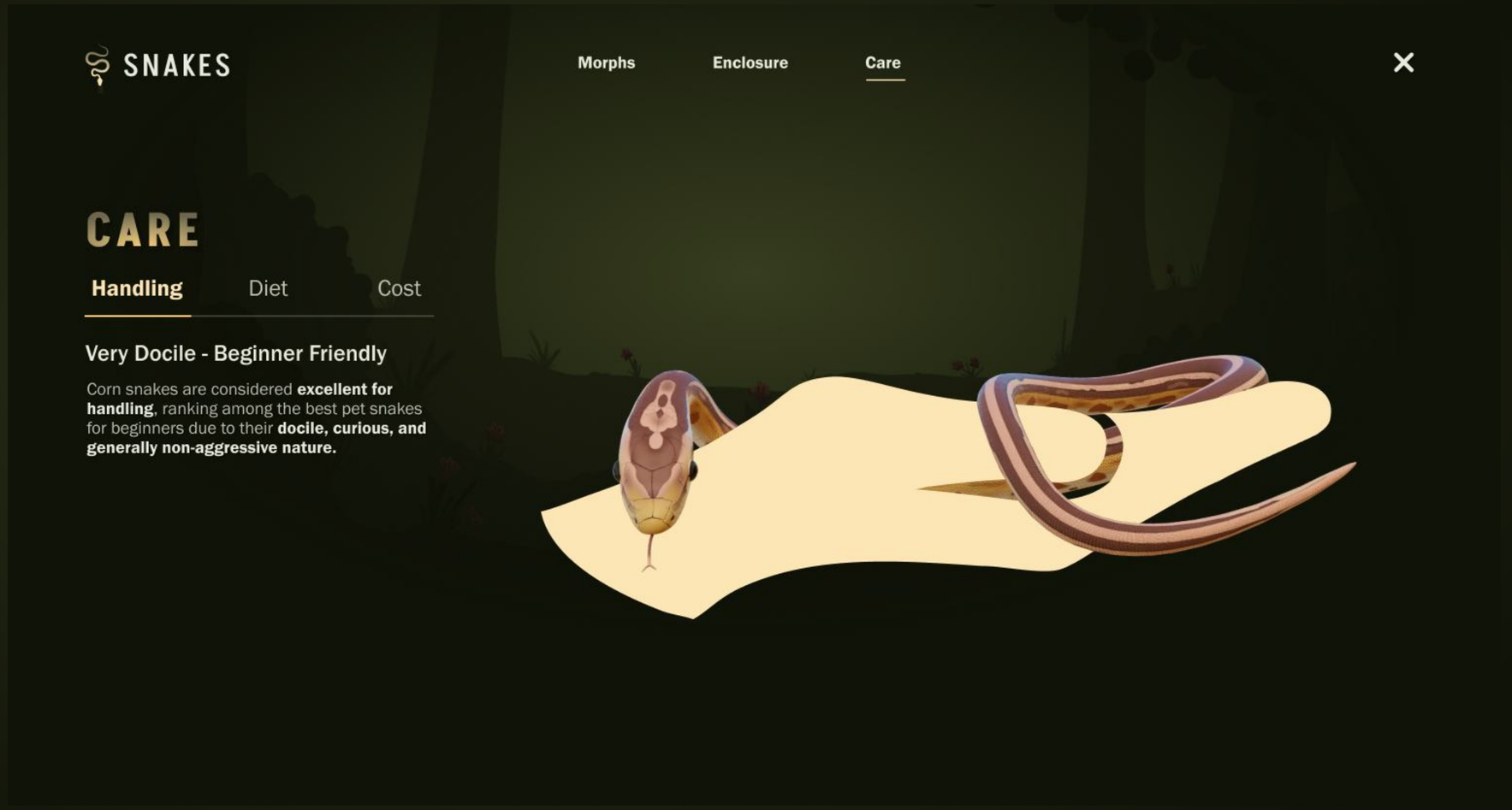
On the enclosure page, the user can learn the basic requirements for housing this snake. The user can rotate the tank and explore items in the tank using the hot spots.



Final Compositions

Care:

On the care page, the user can navigate and learn three options. Handling, diet, and cost.



Prototype

Key Features:

- Animation into enclosure
- Enclosure rotation
- Morph changes
- Interactive hover states
- Hot Spot interaction

Vimeo

Conclusion

Conclusion

Take Aways:

Create a plan that is more manageable from the start. As I continued working on this project, I had to keep condensing the amount of work I wanted to add to this project.

Continue exploring unique solutions as you go. Exploring solutions and finding inspiration for this project has been a great help. If I had more time there are many other things I'd like to try to explore and add to this site.

Lessons Learned:

During this project, I learned a lot about how to incorporate 3D into my designs. While doing this was fun to learn, it was very time consuming and I believe it took away from my UI design. To improve this I need to create a better plan before diving into asset creation. I also need to plan the assets to work more with the UI.

Future Development:

I'd like to return to this project to improve the 3D assets and animation. Transferring and making sure all the 3D assets worked into the prototype was very difficult as there were a lot of factors that needed to be considered each time. Going back and editing 3D render also was not a quick task, therefore more time would allow me to make some improvements in the animations.

Appendix

Sources:

https://www.britannica.com/animal/snake

https://www.havahart.com/snake-facts?srsltid=ARcRdnoy339DWG62yKgKQBggnQ0cZdXaGslj4II-DIW6nX6wB-IHg07w

https://www.tampavet.com/exotics-blog/best-beginner-snakes/

https://www.youtube.com/@ClintsReptiles

https://cornsnake.net/pages/corn-snake-morph-photos

https://www.creaturecarecards.com/cornsnake.html

Thank You